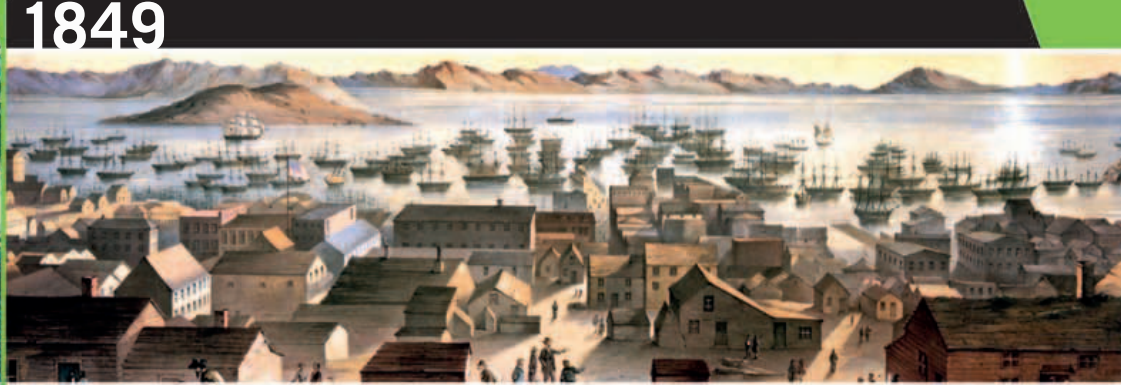




Merchant ships crowd the bay at San Francisco during the gold rush years, when tens of thousands of fortune-seekers arrived in California.

COMMUNISM

With the publication of the *Communist Manifesto* Marx and Engels laid the foundation of a political movement that sought to share the means of production, such as land or factories, equally among the public. Communists aimed to create a classless and stateless society, as well as abolish the capitalist trappings of private property and wage labor.

crowds. The following day, Guizot was forced out of office and Louis-Philippe abdicated from the throne. A provisional government was set up and the **Second Republic** established, eventually producing a constitution and extending the vote. However, internal power struggles led to a workers' rebellion in June. By the end of the year, another Bonaparte was in power—this time Napoleon's nephew, **Prince Louis-Napoleon Bonaparte** (1808–73), who had been elected president.

This unrest was not limited to France. The rebellions had started in Sicily in January, and spread from there. There were a number of factors involved: high food prices, economic depression, **nationalist movements**, desire for **constitutional reforms**, and frustration with monarchies. The revolutions varied in intensity and

success. In some places, they amounted to large-scale protests, such as the **Chartists'** demonstrations for changes to the voting system in Britain, or the call for institutional reforms in Belgium and the Netherlands.

It was in France, the Austrian Empire, Germany, and the Italian states where the real agitation lay. In the **Kingdom of the Two Sicilies** (see map, left), the king was forced to grant a constitution. **Germany** saw street fighting in Berlin in March, with the king of Prussia promising to grant Germany a constitution. **Austria**, too, saw fighting break out in Vienna, and a new government was appointed, while many of its territories, such as **Hungary**, called for more autonomy. In broad terms, however, the events of 1848 **ended in failure** and further social repression.

WITH THE END OF THE WAR

BETWEEN THE US AND MEXICO in 1847, the US gained—through the Treaty of Guadalupe Hidalgo (1848)—a vast area of land that included **California**. The following year, a carpenter named James Wilson Marshall noticed shiny metal nuggets in a river near present-day Sacramento, which he soon realized were **gold**. News of this discovery spread throughout the country—aided by President James K. Polk's announcement—and by 1849 the **rush** had begun. That year some 40,000 people arrived in San Francisco by boat and another 40,000 by wagon train from around the US and other countries. Most of the prospectors ended up empty-handed but many stayed in California, making the West Coast a booming region in the mid-19th century.

In **southern Africa**, a British explorer and missionary named **David Livingstone** (1813–73) had finally reached a lake in the interior that he had heard about—known today as **Lake Ngami**. He had been living in South Africa since 1841 and had been traveling extensively in the region. In order to find this body of water, Livingstone had to cross the **Kalahari Desert**, where he also encountered the Botletle River, which he thought could be “the key to the Interior.”

In **India**, the previous four years had seen two wars between the British East India Company troops and the Sikhs in the northwest. The **First Sikh War** (1845–46) had

been triggered by the death of their ruler Ranjit Singh (1781–1839). Previously, the Company considered Singh's force of 100,000 Khalsa warriors far too powerful to confront. But after his death, British troops moved in and took areas near the border, seizing the city of **Lahore** by 1845. A treaty between the two forced the Sikhs to give up even more territory. A revolt against the British in 1848 triggered the **Second Sikh War**, and by 1849 the Punjab region had been annexed by the British.

Yemen, at the foot of the Arabian Peninsula, was fighting against imperial advances from the **Ottoman Empire**, which was trying to reassert its authority in the Tihama region, on the **Red Sea**. In the south of the country,



Livingstone's compass

The magnetic compass used by David Livingstone, who spent much of his time as a missionary exploring Africa's interior.

the British East India Company had already taken control of the **port of Aden** a decade earlier in order to set up a coaling station for British ships en route to India.

PRE-RAPHAELITES

Three young artists frustrated with the state of British painting at the Royal Academy, where they were students, decided to create a movement to bring a moral seriousness into art—in contrast to the pomposity and frivolity they perceived in Victorian art. Known as the Pre-Raphaelite Brotherhood, Dante Gabriel Rossetti, William Holman Hunt, and John Everett Millais painted religious and romantic subjects with realist clarity, although their work was also symbolic.



“...DISGRACED BY THE STINK OF REVOLUTION, BAKED OF DIRT AND MUD.”

Frederick William IV of Prussia, on the Crown after the 1848 Revolution

October 24 First Schleswig War is fought between Prussia and Denmark (to 1851)

November 1 First medical school for women opens in Boston, Massachusetts

December 2 Emperor Ferdinand I of Austria abdicates for nephew, Emperor Franz Josef I

October 28 First railroad in Spain is opened

November 4 Second Republic established in France with Louis-Napoleon Bonaparte (1808–73) as president

California gold rush begins

January 23 Elizabeth Blackwell becomes first official female medical graduate and doctor in the US

January 31 Corn Laws abolished in Britain

March 30 Britain annexes the Punjab after Second Sikh War (from 1848)

February 9 New Roman Republic declared when Pope flees

June 5 Denmark becomes constitutional monarchy

July 3 Roman Republic surrenders to occupying French troops

April 2 Revolutions in German states end in failure

August 8 Hungarian revolution crushed by Austria with Russian aid

Second Carlist War ends in Spain

November 16 Russian novelist Fyodor Dostoevsky (1821–1881) sentenced to death but antigovernment activities but execution is stayed